



Epilogue

PROSPERO

Now my charms are all o'erthrown,
 And what strength I have's mine own,
 Which is most faint: now, 'tis true,
 I must be here confined by you,
 Or sent to Naples. Let me not,
 Since I have my dukedom got
 And pardon'd the deceiver, dwell
 In this bare island by your spell;
 But release me from my bands
 With the help of your good hands:
 Gentle breath of yours my sails
 Must fill, or else my project fails,
 Which was to please. Now I want
 Spirits to enforce, art to enchant,
 And my ending is despair,
 Unless I be relieved by prayer,
 Which pierces so that it assaults
 Mercy itself and frees all faults.
 As you from crimes would pardon'd be,
 Let your indulgence set me free.

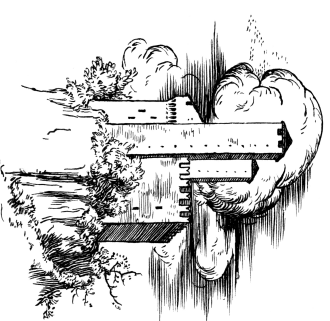
Where I have hope to see the nuptial
 Of these our dear-beloved solemnized;
 And thence retire me to my Milan, where
 Every third thought shall be my grave.

ALONSO

I long
 To hear the story of your life, which must
 Take the ear strangely.

PROSPERO

I'll deliver all;
 And promise you calm seas, auspicious gales
 And sail so expeditious that shall catch
 Your royal fleet far off. *[Aside to ARIEL] My Ariel, chick,*
That is thy charge: then to the elements
Be free, and fare thou well! Please you, draw near.
(Exeunt)



STEPHANO

I should have been a sore one then.

ALONSO

(Pointing to CALIBAN) This is a strange thing as e'er I look'd on.

PROSPERO

He is as disproportion'd in his manners
As in his shape. *(To CALIBAN)* Go, sirrah, to my cell;
Take with you your companions; as you look
To have my pardon, trim it handsomely.

CALIBAN

Ay, that I will; and I'll be wise hereafter
And seek for grace. What a thrice-double ass
Was I, to take this drunkard for a god
And worship this dull fool!

PROSPERO

Go to; away!

ALONSO

(to STEPHANO and TRINCULO) Hence, and bestow your luggage where
you found it.

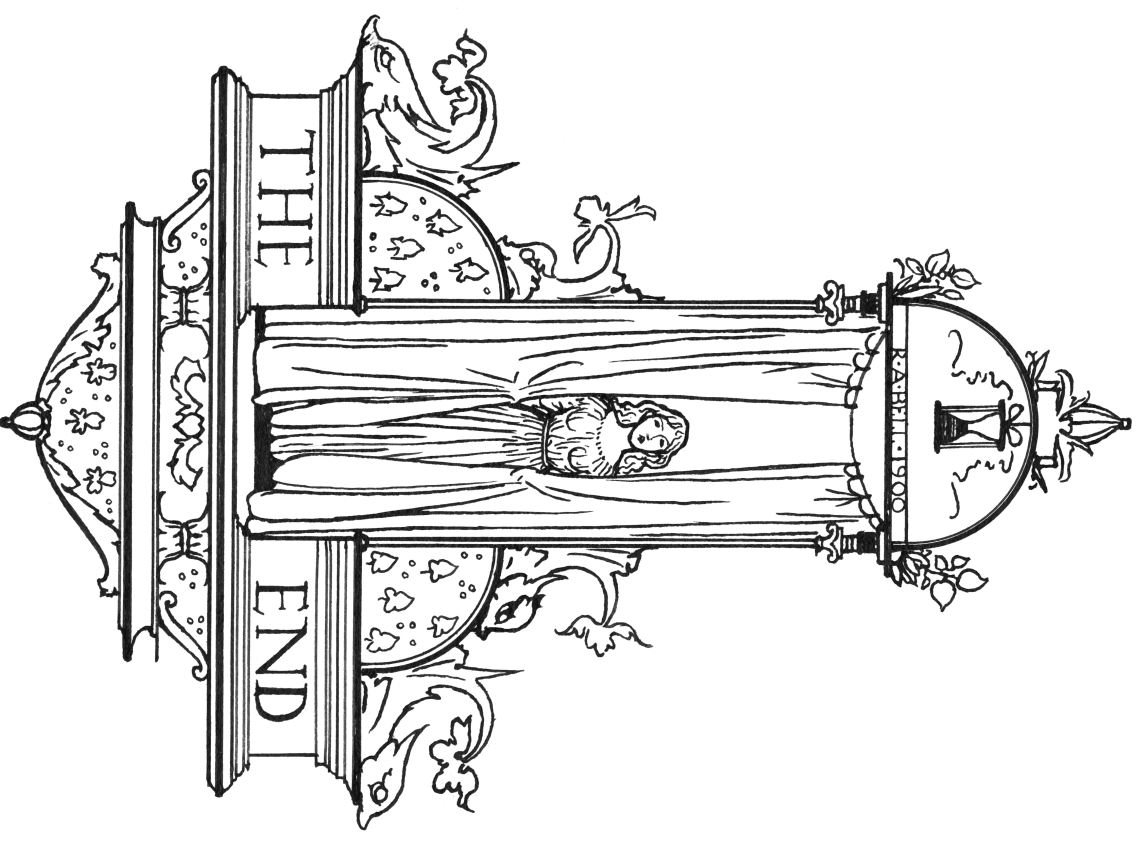
SEBASTIAN

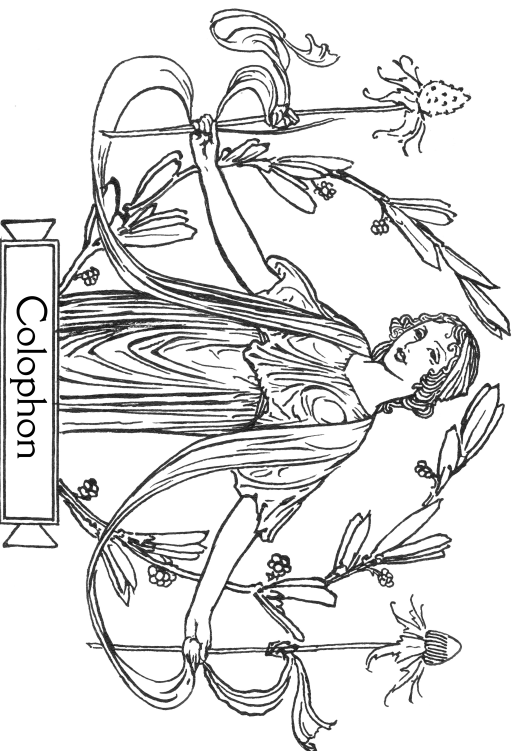
Or stole it, rather.

(Exit CALIBAN, STEPHANO, and TRINCULO)

PROSPERO

Sir, I invite your highness and your train
To my poor cell, where you shall take your rest
For this one night; which, part of it, I'll waste
With such discourse as, I not doubt, shall make it
Go quick away; the story of my life
And the particular accidents gone by
Since I came to this isle: and in the morn
I'll bring you to your ship and so to Naples,





Colophon

The Tempest was probably written in 1610 or 1611, not long before William Shakespeare (1564–1616) retired from the stage and returned to his native Stratford-upon-Avon. It was first published by William Jaggard in London, in 1623, as part of *Mr. William Shakespeare's Comedies, Histories, & Tragedies; Published according to the True and Originall Copies: the so-called 'First Folio'.* Illustrations by British artist Robert Anning Bell (1863–1933) are from a 1901 edition published in London (UK) by Freemantle & Co. Grateful acknowledgement is made to the Folger Shakespeare Library in Washington D.C. (USA) for making available excellent-quality scans.

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PROSPERO

Mark but the badges of these men, my lords,
 Then say if they be true. This mis-shapen knave,
 His mother was a witch, and one so strong
 That could control the moon, make flows and ebbs,
 And deal in her command without her power.
 These three have robb'd me; and this demi-devil—
 For he's a bastard one—had plotted with them
 To take my life. Two of these fellows you
 Must know and own; this thing of darkness I
 Acknowledge mine.

CALIBAN

I shall be pinch'd to death.

ALONSO

Is not this Stephano, my drunken butler?

SEBASTIAN

He is drunk now: where had he wine?

ALONSO

And Trinculo is reeling ripe: where should they
 Find this grand liquor that hath gilded 'em?
 (*To Trinculo*) How earnest thou in this pickle?

TRINCULO

I have been in such a pickle since I saw you last that, I fear me, will never
 out of my bones: I shall not fear fly-blowing.

SEBASTIAN

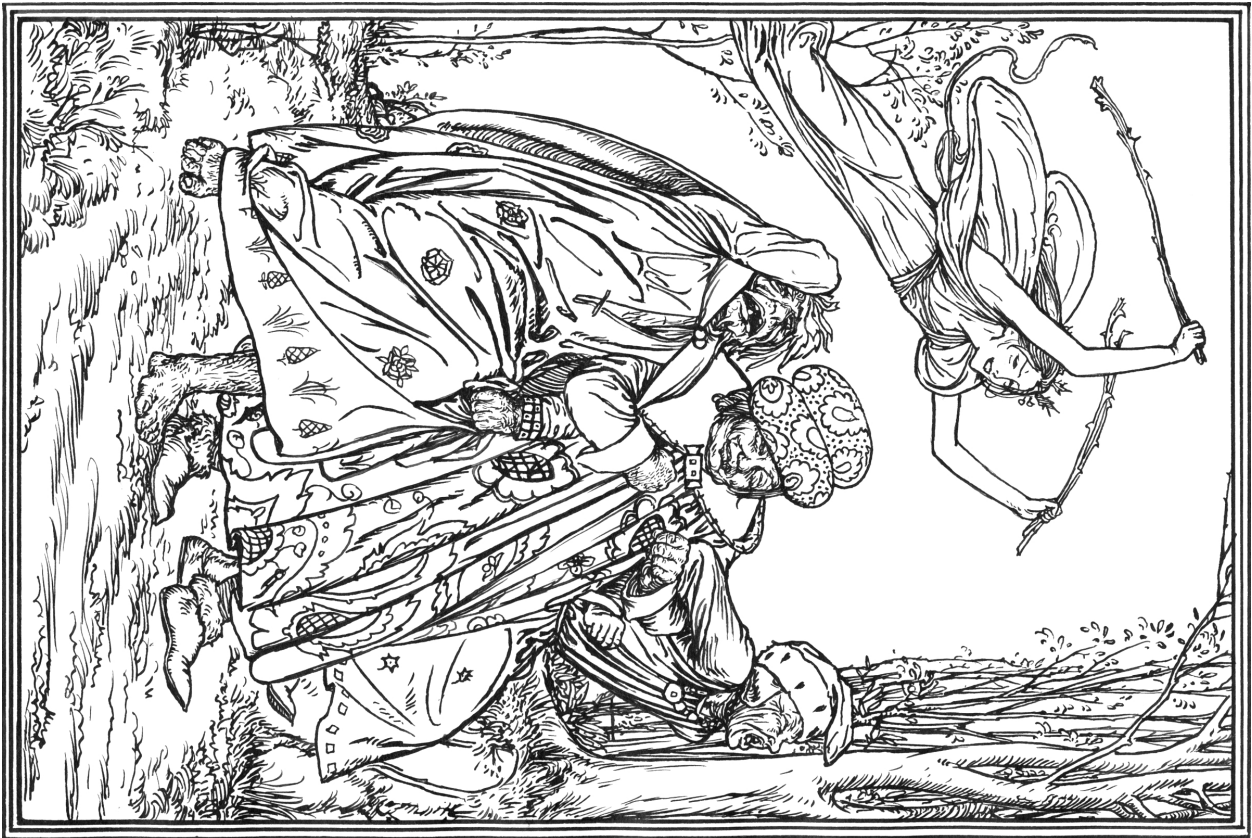
Why, how now, Stephano!

STEPHANO

O, touch me not; I am not Stephano, but a cramp.

PROSPERO

You'd be king o' the isle, sirrah?



PROSPERO

Sir, my liege,
Do not infest your mind with beating on
The strangeness of this business; at pick'd leisure
Which shall be shortly, single I'll resolve you,
Which to you shall seem probable, of every
These happen'd accidents; till when, be cheerful
And think of each thing well. *[Aside to ARIEL] Come hither, spirit:
Set Caliban and his companions free;
Untie the spell.*

(Exit ARIEL)

How fares my gracious sir?
There are yet missing of your company
Some few odd lads that you remember not.
*(Re-enter ARIEL, driving in CALIBAN, STEPHANO and TRINCULO, in
their stolen apparel)*

STEPHANO

Every man shift for all the rest, and let no man take care for himself; for
all is but fortune. Coragio, bully-monster, coragio!

TRINCULO

If these be true spies which I wear in my head, here's a goodly sight.

CALIBAN

O Setebos, these be brave spirits indeed!
How fine my master is! I am afraid
He will chastise me.

SEBASTIAN

Ha, ha!
What things are these, my lord Antonio?
Will money buy 'em?

ANTONIO

Very like; one of them
Is a plain fish, and, no doubt, marketable.